



Skype 5 to 25

Skype goes on and increases the support of number of people from 5 to 25 on its Android and iOS apps. <http://dgit.in/Skype25>



Star Wars 35mm

The original Star Wars Episode IV: A New Hope 35mm film from 1977 has been restored in HD version. <http://dgit.in/Star35mm>

FUN FACT

Laurens Hammond, in December 1922, premiered the world's first alternating-frame 3D viewing system, known as the Televue. Using separate prints for each eye and an interlocking projector system, frames for each eye were presented alternately to the other eye. Each frame was shown three times to reduce flicker, and custom viewing devices were synchronised with the projector to give the viewers a 'clean' 3D experience. Hammond would later invent the Hammond Organ, a device that took its operational principles from the Telharmonium - a massive instrument that is hailed as the origin of music streaming in any form, one that we covered in our last month's origin story of music streaming.

feature film to have stereophonic sound). Another impact that 3D films had on the history of films is in forming the juncture of an intermission in films. With two films having to be played via two separate projectors, the largest reel length possible to be loaded on to a projector was approximately of one hour. This often meant that a break within the films was necessary to continue screening the entire film, and as a result, filmmakers started incorporating the factor of the intermission as a pivotal crisis point in the films, thereby maintaining the heightened attention of the audience intact through the interval.

The golden era of 3D movies was short lived, and demand and production of 3D films gradually started declining by late 1954. Among the reasons that initiated the decline was the effort required to synchronise and maintain two separate reels with precise coordination, shooting cost, and the unusability of side seats in a theatre because of the directional silver screen (essential reflective surface for the working of Polaroid filters) leading to lower profits of movie theatres. Among the movies that

brought 3D films to the audience and gathered considerable interest were Alfred Hitchcock's *Dial M for Murder* and *Son of Sinbad*, an RKO/Howard production.

Signs of resurgence

About a decade later, the 1960s saw 3D films attempting a revival. Coincidentally, Arch Oboler was yet again the man behind 3D's slow resurgence. His usage of Space Vision 3D, a technology that allowed 3D films to be played on a single strip and using a special, Trioptiscope Space-Vision lens, deemed the restrictions imposed by dual-strip playback minimal. However, the result obtained was darker and more polarised than what was seen earlier.

In 1969, the advent of Stereovision proved to be a groundbreaker in the world of 3D films. A 35mm single strip format could now play 3D films, and the film *The Stewardesses* that cost \$100,000 to be produced back then, went on to become a phenomenal success. It is the highest grossing 3D film till date, eventually earning a consolidated sum of \$140 million over time, and becoming one of the most successful films (in terms of investment and returns) ever made. Stereovision became the basis of 3D films for a span of almost 25 years, following the success of this film.



The Stewardesses has been one of the most profitable films of all time

IMAX's three-dimensional success

The rise of IMAX and its experiments with 3D gave rise to a newer chapter in 3D vision, in the late 1980s. IMAX began producing non-fiction 3D films, like *Transitions* in 1986 and *Echoes of the Sun* in 1990. IMAX's dome screen became a significant entity of its 3D screening process, and *Echoes of the Sun* became the first film to be screened using

alternate-eye shutterglass technology. In between the '90s and the latest resurgence in computer graphics-powered 3D action like *Avatar* (2009), significant 3D films produced and screened by IMAX include *Wings of Courage* (1996), *T-Rex: Back to the Cretaceous* (1998) and *Space Station 3D* (2002).

James Cameron's *Ghosts of the Abyss* in 2003 saw the advent of the first, digital HD IMAX camera. It became the first film to have been shot in IMAX's Reality Camera System. Another film that was shot with the same technology but arguably varying finesse was *Spy Kids 3D: Game Over*, by Robert Rodriguez in 2003. In 2004, *The Polar Express* became the world's first animated 3D film, leading to the advent of films *Avatar*, *Bolt*, *Life of*



Avatar was pivotal in respawning interest in 3D

Pi, *The Adventures of Tintin*, *Superman Returns* and the latest, *Star Wars: The Force Awakens*.

Computer-generated graphics have led to increasing finesse, and the stunning display of visuals that *Avatar* and *Life of Pi* stand for. Today, 3D viewing has reached our homes with 3D televisions becoming increasingly commonplace, and even smartphones incorporating naked eye 3D viewing. The market for 3D films, however, has seen a reported drop of interest, possibly owing to the fact that 3D is not a novel artifact to be marveled at, any more. Additionally, with the rise of virtual reality, we are not restricted to a perceived depth of space with our eyes, but can now immerse ourselves in a digitally-simulated and artificially scaled world that not only perceives depth of vision, but also simulates physical movement in the virtual world. 3D may not be dying out immediately, but its days certainly seem to be numbered. **d**